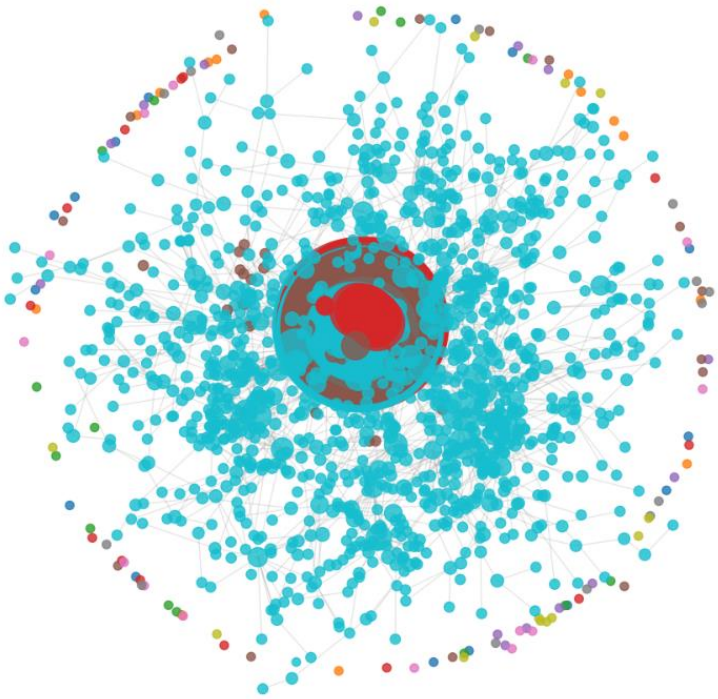
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1. Relatedness network – 2016

The network has 2466 nodes and 286270 links. There are 143 communities. The maximum k-core number is 373, and the numbers of core nodes are 478. It means, there are 2466 unique products with 286270 links/edges. At the very center of this network, there is a core product group where every single node (product) is directly connected to at least 373 other products within that same product group. Out of the entire network, 478 nodes belong to this deepest, most connected core.



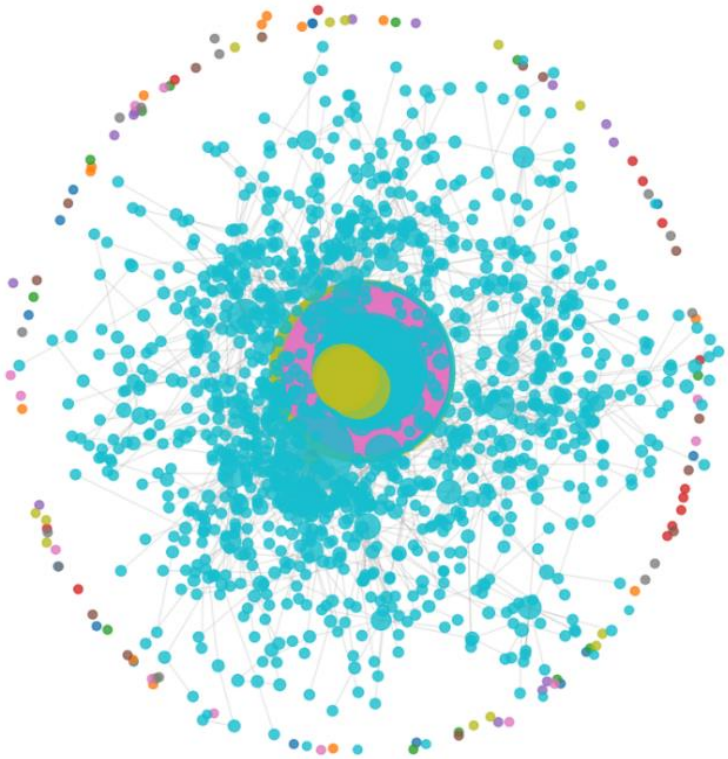
1. Figure: Relatedness Network - 2016

For 2016, the core at the center of the network (red/brown sphere) is stable, balanced, and very compact. During normal periods, this symbolizes the close interconnection between global supply chains and key industrial products. However, there also some products on the periphery (unfortunately, I cannot name them because I couldn't find the product sector/category classification or the product names – only their codes on the site of *Atlas of Economic Complexity*). The “cloud” of blue dots is distributed evenly around the red/brown core center, indicating that a wide variety of products were connected in the global trade in 2016.

2. Relatedness network – 2020

The network has 2461 nodes and 320925 links. There are 132 communities. The maximum k-core number is 446, and the numbers of core nodes are 618. It means, there are 2461 unique products with 286270 links/edges. So, from 2016 to 2020, the numbers of products decreased, while the numbers of edges increased. At the very center of this network, there is a core product group where every single node (product) is directly connected to at least 446 other products within that same product group (bigger core product group compared to 2016). Out of the entire network, 618 nodes (product) belong to this deepest, most connected core.

The structure of the center visibly changed (shades of yellow/green, pink and blue), presumably due to the coronavirus pandemic (COVID-19), which disrupted the global market in 2020. Traditional product relationships have been transformed, while certain sectors (such as healthcare, personal protective equipment, pharmaceuticals, and digital devices) have suddenly become the absolute center of attention and economic connections.



2. Figure: Relatedness Network - 2020

The isolated nodes on the periphery and the edges stand out from the core. Due to lockdowns, factory shutdowns, and transportation disruptions, many products and industries have temporarily lost their usual points of connection or have been forced onto an isolated path. The network clearly illustrates that the pandemic did not wipe out the network but rather shifted its structure. The "relatedness" between products adapted to the crisis: what was previously peripheral could become an important economic link due to the pandemic.

3. Correlation

Correlation of the edge weights in the 2016 and 2020 proximity matrices: 0.7885. A correlation score of 0.7885 is quite high. It means that despite the massive disruptions of the COVID-19 pandemic in 2020, the fundamental relationships between products remained stable compared to 2016. Products that were closely connected in 2016 generally stayed closely connected in 2020.